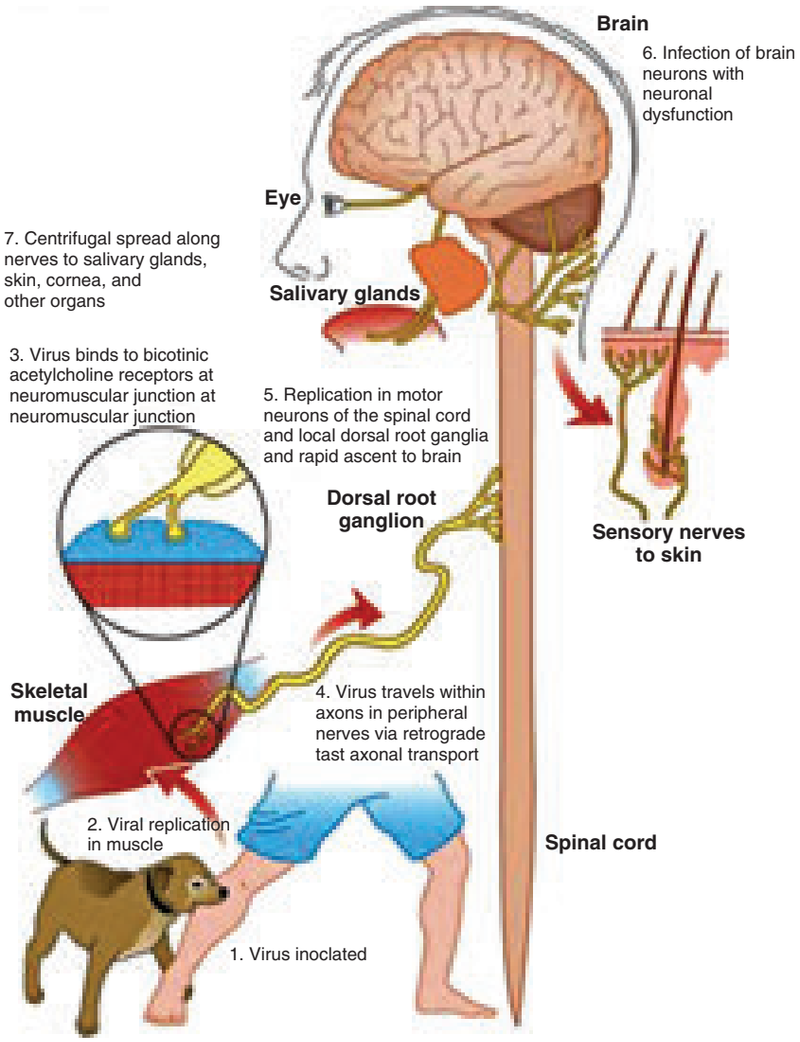


Figure 10.7: Mechanism of Rabies Infection

the site of deposition for 48-72 hours. It penetrates the **nerve endings** and travels in the axoplasm towards the **spinal cord and brain**, at speed of about 3 mm per hour. The virus multiples and **spreads centrifugally** along the nerve trunks to various parts of the body including the salivary glands. It multiplies in the salivary glands and is **shed** in the **saliva**. The virus reaches every tissue in the body and disseminated may be interrupted at any stage by death. In humans the incubation period is usually from **1–3 months**, short as 7 days or as long as three year. The incubation period is usually short in persons bitten on the face or head and long in those bitten on the legs. This may be related to the distance the virus has to travel to reach the brain. The incubation period is generally shorter in children than in adults.

The **four stages** of the disease are as follows, **prodrome, acute encephalitic phase, coma and death**. The onset is market by symptoms such as fever, headache, malaise, fatigue and anorexia. Anxiety, agitation, irritability, nervousness, insomnia or depression. The neurological phase begins with hyperactivity. Attempts to drink on such painful spasms of the

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